

function, and Turn off & Lock, among several others.

Make HotSync Wait Forever

If your Palm device gets impatient and times out waiting for your PC to make a connection during a HotSync, there's a Developer's Backdoor in the Palm OS which you can use to force your device to wait until a connection is made.

Open the HotSync Application. Press and hold the up and down scroll buttons simultaneously with your left thumb, and use the stylus in your right hand to double-tap in the uppermost right corner of the screen. A small dialog box titled "Developer's Backdoor" should open up, containing the text "DLServer Wait Forever is ON". Click on OK, and your device will now wait until your PC makes a connection.

Resetting Without Data Loss

If your Palm device is misbehaving and you don't want to lose your data in a hard reset, you can try resetting the Palm OS instead.

You'll need a bent paper clip for this. Press and hold down the up scroll button and at the same time, use the paper clip to reset the device (the reset port is a small pinhole at the back of the device). Release the up scroll button when you see the Palm Startup screen.

Cursor Tricks In Graffiti

To do a backspace when using graffiti, make a horizontal right-to-left stroke on the graffiti area. If, however, you just want to move the cursor to the left, make a continuous left-right stroke: start at the right side of the graffiti area, stroke to the left and then stroke back to the right without lifting the stylus.

Similarly, you can move the cursor one step to the right by making a continuous right to left stroke.

Create Your Own ShortCuts

A ShortCut is a code that

inserts a commonly used phrase when combined with the ShortCut stroke in the graffiti area. The graffiti ShortCut stroke is easy—much like the cursive letter L. Start at the bottom left, move upward and towards the right, loop around and move towards the bottom right.

Suppose you use the phrase "Meeting With" a lot. You could assign a shortcut called "MW", which will just insert the phrase for you.

In the Application launcher, open the Prefs application, and tap the drop-down box in the upper right corner. Select ShortCuts, and tap New. In the line under ShortCut Name, write "MW". In the line under ShortCut Text, enter the full text—"Meeting With". To use this shortcut in a memo, first make the ShortCut stroke (which will now appear on the line), and then write out the ShortCut name ("MW" in this case). Your ShortCut text should appear on the line in an instant!

Windows Mobile Pocket PCs and Phones

Applies to Smartphones from O2 and iMate, and PDAs like the HP iPAQ

Get MSN Messenger In The Start Menu

Windows Mobile 5 comes with PocketMSN, which combines MSN Messenger, Hotmail and a couple of other programs in the same interface. This makes starting up Messenger a more tedious task than it should be. To make MSN Messenger accessible in a single tap, follow these steps: start File Explorer and navigate to the \Windows folder. Look for "instmsg"; tap on it and hold to bring up the menu, and select Copy. Now navigate to \Windows\Start Menu\Programs. Select Menu > Edit > Paste Shortcut. You can now rename this shortcut to "MSN Messenger" or anything else.

Change Opera's Behaviour On Windows Mobile

In the Opera 8.5 beta for Windows Mobile, you will

notice that when you try to scroll through Web pages, you're actually taken from link to link. This can get extremely annoying if you're viewing a site with lots of links. To get around this, use any file editor to edit

\Application
Data\Opera\input.ini.

Change:

Up = Navigate up
Down = Navigate down
to:

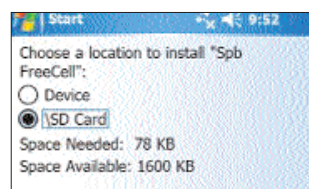
Up = Page up
Down = Page down
Sites will now scroll page

by page.

Reinstalling Software To A Flash Memory Card (Windows Mobile 5)

To save internal memory, you can reinstall existing applications to your extendable memory card instead.

Go to Tools > Add/Remove Programs in Microsoft ActiveSync, and locate the program you want to reinstall.



Relocate programs to a Flash card

Deselect the checkbox next to it to uninstall it from your Pocket PC (the installation files will remain on your Desktop PC, though). Close Add/Remove Programs and start it again.

Now check the box next to the software to install it. You will be asked where you want to install the program—simply choose "\SD Card" and click Install.

Really Close Applications

Contrary to what it suggests, the X button doesn't close an application—it only minimises it. To really save your system resources and close the program, you have to click on Start > Settings > System and select the Memory icon. From there, click on the Running Programs tab to end your tasks. You could also use a freeware task manager such as vBar or PocketNav.

You Can Overclock Your PocketPC Too!

If you want to push your PocketPC to the limit, try overclocking it using third-party tools such as Immiersoft's XCPUScalar or Pocket Hack Master from Anton Tomov. You should back up all your data first, because overclocking can cause your device to freeze or hard reset—which will wipe out all your data and settings.

Switch screen orientation quickly

If you find yourself wanting to switch between portrait and landscape mode often, assign a button for it. Tap Start > Settings > Buttons and select the button you want to assign. Under "Assign a Program", select "Rotate Screen" and click OK. From now on, you can use this button to switch orientations quickly.

Get the most out of the battery

Go to Start > Settings > System > Power. In the Advanced tab, set your device to turn off in 3 minutes or less to conserve battery power.

If you're ever using a CompactFlash card or interfacing with any peripherals, use the AC adapter to save your battery.

Unless you really need a bright backlight, turn it down—go to Start > Settings > System > Backlight > Brightness. Turn down the brightness to the lowest setting you're comfortable with.

Make the battery last longer

How long your battery power lasts depends on battery type and how you use your device. Try the following to help preserve battery life:

- o Tap Start > Settings > System > Power. On the Advanced tab, you can specify when your device turns off to conserve battery power. For optimum conservation, specify 3 minutes or less.
- o Use the AC adapter to plug your device into external power whenever possible, especially when using a CompactFlash card or when using a modem or other peripherals.
- o Adjust the backlight settings.